A series of five thick, black, hand-drawn vertical lines of varying lengths and slightly irregular edges, positioned on the left side of the page.

KIAN RAVAEI

**SARI GELIN &
WILDWOOD
FLOWER**

(FROM *GULISTAN*)

for mezzo-soprano
and piano

ÆI edition

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(2023)

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*Gulistan commissioned by Chamber Music Northwest
with the generous support of the CMNW Commissioning Fund.*

*This arrangement commissioned by Feride Büyükdenktas.
Funding has been made possible by The Puffin Foundation.*

PROGRAM NOTE

In *Sari Gelin & Wildwood Flower*, I bring together traditional songs from my Western and Middle Eastern heritage: the traditional Azerbaijani song “Sari Gelin” and the American folk song “Wildwood Flower.” The former describes a man helplessly longing for his distant lover, while the latter tells the story of a heartbroken woman whose lover has abandoned her. I intertwine the songs, suggesting a dialogue between two inconsolable lovers, each pining for the other.

—Kian Ravaei

duration ca. 9'

TEXT & TRANSLATION

Sāchīn üjün hörmazlar
gülü sooloo darmazlar
sāri galin

1)

*The tassels at the end of your hair,
The dewy bud of your rose,
Blonde bride.*

I'll twine 'mid the ringlets of my long flaxen hair,
The lillies so pale and the roses so fair,
The myrtle so bright with an emerald hue,
And the pale aronatus with eyes of bright blue.

2)

Boo sevdā na sevdādīr
sanee mana vermazlar
neynim āmān āmān
sāri galin

1)

*What kind of love is this love!
They will not give you to me.
What can I do? Please, please!
Blonde bride.*

I'll think of him never, I'll be wildly gay,
I'll charm ev'ry heart and the crowd I will sway,
I'll live yet to see him regret the dark hour
When he won, then neglected, the frail wildwood
flower.

2)

Boo daranin oozoonoo
chobān gāytār goozoonoo
sāri galin

1)

*The tallest of this valley,
Shepherd, return the lamb,
Blonde bride.*

He taught me to love him, he call'd me his flower
That blossom'd for him all the brighter each hour;
But I woke from my dreaming, my idol was clay;
My visions of love have all faded away.

2)

Na olā bir gün göram
nāzli yārīn üzünü
neynim āmān āmān
sāri galin

1)

*I hope that I may one day see
The beautiful face of my beloved.
What can I do? Please, please!
Blonde bride.*

1) Azerbaijani Traditional, "Sarı Gəlin"

Translation by Kian Ravaei with assistance from Marjan Azimi.

2) Maud Irving (1840–1884), from "I'll Twine' Mid The Ringlets"

TRANSLITERATION PRONUNCIATION GUIDE

Vowels	Consonants
a = m <u>a</u> t	g = game
ā = f <u>a</u> ll	gh = like a guttural "g" (voiceless uvular plosive)
e = n <u>e</u> t	j = joy
ee = k <u>ee</u> n	kh = "ch" in the German word <i>dach</i> (voiceless uvular fricative)
ey = pr <u>ey</u>	y = year
i = b <u>i</u> t	(All remaining consonants are the same as in English.)
ï = "oo" with unrounded lips (close back unrounded vowel)	
o = b <u>o</u> wl	
ö = <u>œ</u> uvre (French)	
oo = p <u>oo</u> l	
ü = <u>ü</u> ber (German)	

To aid with pronunciation, a spoken recording of the text may be accessed at:
kianravaei.com/downloads/sari-gelin.mp3

IPA TRANSCRIPTION

Sāchīn üjün hörmazlar
[sa.tʃɪn y.ɟyn hœr.mæz.lær]
The tassels at the end of your hair,

gölü sooloo darmazlar
[gy.ly su.lu dær.mæz.lær]
The dewy bud of your rose,

sāri galin
[sa.rɪ gæ.lɪn]
Blonde bride.

Boo sevdā na sevdādīr
[bu sev.da næ sev.da.duɪr]
What kind of love is this love!

sanee mana vermazlar
[sæ.ni mæ.næ ver.mæz.lær]
They will not give you to me.

neynim āmān āmān
[nej.nɪm a.man a.man]
What can I do? Please, please!

sāri galin
[sa.rɪ gæ.lɪn]
Blonde bride.

Boo daranin oozoonoo
[bu dæ.ræ.nɪn u.zu.nu]
The tallest of this valley,

chobān gāytār goofoonoo
[tʃo.ban gaj.tar gu.zu.nu]
Shepherd, return the lamb,

sāri galin
[sa.rɪ gæ.lɪn]
Blonde bride.

Na olā bir gün göram
[næ o.la bɪr gyn gœ.ræm]
I hope that I may one day see

nāzli yārīn üzünü
[naz.lɪ ja.ruɪn y.zy.ny]
The beautiful face of my beloved.

neynim āmān āmān
[nej.nɪm a.man a.man]
What can I do? Please, please!

sāri galin
[sa.rɪ gæ.lɪn]
Blonde bride.

ANALYSIS

I changed the lyric “raven black hair” from “I’ll Twine ‘Mid The Ringlets” to “long flaxen hair” in order to suggest the blonde bride of “Sari Gelin.” Both melodies feature vocal embellishments inspired by their respective folk traditions.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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to Feride Büyükdentkas

SARI GELIN & WILDWOOD FLOWER

Azerbaijani Traditional, Maud Irving

Kian Ravaei
(2023)

Melancholy (con rubato) ♩ = ca. 66

Mezzo-
Soprano

Piano

mf *f* *quasi bell-tone* *mf*

Red. as needed *Red.* * *Red.*

6 *rit.* *a tempo*

(grace notes always before the beat)

f *mf* *p*

(*Red.*) * *Red.*

Freely ♩ = 38

p heartbroken

12 *p* heartbroken

Sā - chīn ü - jūn hōr - maz-lar gü - lü soo-loo

8va (l.h. over)

p delicate

(*Red.*) *

16

dar - maz-lar sã - ri ga - lin Sã - chĩn ü - jũn_ hör - maz-lar_

pp lamentoso

20

rit. *mf* *p* Simply flowing ♩ = 66

gũ - lũ_ soo-loo dar - maz-lar_ sã - ri ga - lin_

mf *p delicate*

8va

7

25

p simple, with a touch of longing

I'll twine 'mid the ring - lets of my long flax - en_ hair

pp

(8)

(Xed.)

*

30

The lil - lies so pale and the ro - ses_ so_ fair,

(8)

p espr. *pp*

35

The myr - tle_ so_ bright with an em - erald hue,

(8)

p espr. *pp*

40

And the pale a - ro - na - tus with eyes of_ bright blue.

(8)

ppp *p dark* *loco*

rit.

46 a tempo, più rubato

rit.

a tempo

46 a tempo, più rubato

rit. a tempo

espr.

p.

Freely ♩ = 38

p heartbroken

52

Boo sev - dā na sev - dā-dīr

8^{va}

pp

6

57

(gliss.)

sa - nee ma - na ver - maz - lar ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn

pp lamentoso

61

sā - ri ga - lin

Boo sev - dā na sev - dā - dīr

freely

mf sonore

64

sa - nee ma - na ver - maz - lar

ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn

p

67

rit. **Maestoso** ♩ = 66
mf

ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn

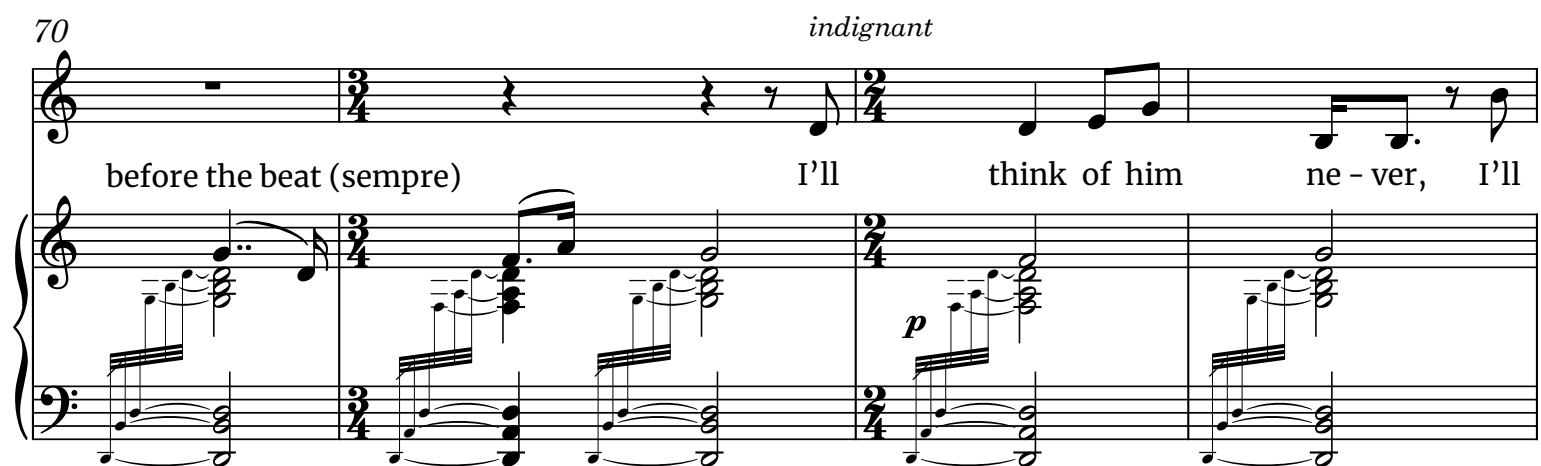
sā - ri ga - lin

on the beat

mf *risoluto, espr.*

70 *indignant*

before the beat (sempre) I'll think of him ne - ver, I'll



74 (gliss.)

be wild - ly gay, I'll



77

charm ev' - ry heart and the crowd I will sway,



81

I'll live yet to see him re-

84

- gret the dark hour When he won, then ne-glec-

88

rit. *p*

Mournful ♩. = 38

- - ted, the frail wild-wood flow'r.

8va

p cant. ed espr.

pp dolce

92

dolce cant.

(8)

p

96

rit.

tr m

freely, espr.

cant.

tr m

pp

tr m

a tempo, freely

100

pp

Boo da - ra - nin oo - zoo-noo cho-bân gâ-y-târ goo - zoo-noo sâ - ri ga - lin

8va

leggiere

105

Boo da - ra - nin oo - - zoo-noo_ cho - bân gâ-y-târ goo - zoo-noo

rit. **Flowing, but heavy** ♩ = 66 *f* *mfanguished*

109

sā - - ri ga - - lin_ He

f *mfanguished*

6

5

8va

113

taught me to love_ him, he call'd me_ his flow'r_ That

p *f espr.*

(8)

118

p

blos - som'd for him all the bright - er_ each hour; But I

p

f espr.

(8)

123

mf

rit. p

woke_ from my dream - ing, My i - dol was clay; My

p sub.

129

a tempo

rit. pp

a tempo

vi - sions of love have all fa - ded a - way.

cant.

135

rit. a tempo

135

rit. a tempo

cresc.....

142

rit.

Poco meno mosso (♩ = ca. 62)

142

rit.

Poco meno mosso (♩ = ca. 62)

ff

p

cresc.....

rit.

Freely ♩ = 38

p heartbroken

148

148

rit.

Freely ♩ = 38

p heartbroken

Na o - lā bir gün gö - ram

f

p sub.

pp

153

nāz - li yā - rīn ü - - zü - - - nū ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn

p *sonore*

156

ney-nim ā - măn ā - măn sā - rī ga - lin Na o - lā bir___ gün_ gö-ram

mf

8ba
p *lontano*

160

nāz - li yā - rīn ü - - zü - - - nū___ ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn

p

dim. poco a poco

8ba

163 rit. *pp* *a piacere* Come prima ♩ = ca. 66

ney - nim ā - măn ā - măn sã - ri ga - lin

ppp *p*

7 8^{ba}-----

167 *p* 3 *pp* 3

Mm Mm

8^{va}----- 1 8^{va}----- 1

f *p* *f*

(*Red.*) * *Red.* *

174 rit. al fine

p *pp*

Red. *

